

COMMUNICATIVE ENGLISH

MODULE -3

SYLLABUS-(Elements of Written and Oral Communication)

- **Letter Writing:**

Formal and Informal letters

Application Writing

Cover letter

- **Resume Writing**

- **Email Etiquettes.**

- **Report Writing:** Types, significance and layouts of report writing.

- **Presentation Strategies / Planning of Public Speaking:**

Purpose

Scope

Understanding audience and Locale

Organizing Contents

Audio Visual Aids

Public speaking methods and techniques

Overcoming stage Fear

Kinesics

Paralinguistics

Proxemics

Chronemics

Haptics

Question-1 Draft a job application letter.

Ans-

JOB APPLICATION LETTER

ABC

C-232 Pavan Vihar

Nagpur, 2260001

June 16, 2025

The Manager

Tata Consultancy Services

Bangalore.

Dear Sir

This is in response to the advertisement published in the 'Times of India' for the post of software engineer in your company. Please find the details given below.

I have completed my Senior secondary and High school education from one of the top schools of Nagpur. I was the topper of my school in class 12th board examination. I obtained overall 97% and had 98% marks in Computer Science. I obtained a high percentage in B. Tech examination which is reflected in my resume. From May 2024 to May 2025, I did my summer training from a top-notch mutual funds company GROWW. Besides academics I have taken keen interest in co-curricular activities like debates and quizzes. I was the cultural head for the college festival in 2023.

If your requirement matches my profile, I shall be happy to come across to meet you in person.

Thanking you,

Yours Sincerely

XYZ

Ques-2) Draft a resume for the post of a software engineer in Tata Consultancy Services.

And- *A resume is usually written while applying for a job. It is the record of the candidate's background, education, skills and achievements.*

RESUME

ABC

Flat no 5, Golden Plaza

River Bank Colony, Lucknow

Contact no-8674325980

Email- elizabeth@gmail.com

Objective: A dynamic individual with a zeal for innovation in technology.

Education

- B. Tech in Computer Science from Babu Banarsi Das University, Lucknow in July 2024 with 90% marks.
- Intermediate from St Stephens college (ICSE board), Lucknow in 2021 with 97% marks.
- High School from St Stephens college, Lucknow in 2019 with 95% marks.

Skills

- Knowledge of Python
- Knowledge of the French language
- Effective Communication skills

Hobbies and Extra-curricular Activities

- Reading
- Dramatics
- Creative writing
- Photography

Achievements

- I was declared the best NCC student of the year 2023.
- Directed a play during the cultural festival (Utkarsh 2023) of BBD University which bagged the first prize.

Question3- Write a note on e-mail etiquettes.

Ans - E-mail is electronic mail. It is a digital message which can be sent through an internet connection.

Many companies are promoting the use of e-mails because a lot of internal and external communication depends on e- mails.

E-mail Etiquettes

- Give a prompt reply.
- Keep it to the point.
- Do not write the whole mail in capital letters.
- Avoid long sentences.
- Prefer active voice.
- Do not attach unnecessary files.
- Do not discuss confidential matter.
- Do not reply to the spams.

Advantages of E-Mails

- Fast Communication.
- Can access vast pool of information on the internet.
- Letter, notes, data and reports can be sent using emails.
- The received e-mails can be dealt in the leisure time.
- Inexpensive.

Limitations

- It is insecure.
- The identity of the sender can be masked completely.
- E- mails cannot be retracted.
- It is possible to forge mails.
- Chances of phishing.
- Identity threats.
- We can receive too many unwanted mails.

Sample E-mail of Complaint

To: The Chairman

Haryana Electricity Board

Chandigarh

From: The Secretary

Resident Welfare Association

Sector 8, Faridabad

Subject: Fault in electronic utility meter.

Sir,

The electronic utility meters in sector 8, Faridabad may have manufacturing defect. Please appoint a third party to check it. Since the installation of electricity utility meters in 2024, the monthly bills of the residents have nearly tripled. After our continuous complaints to the customer services department only two linesmen came to resolve the issue. They left the problem as it is.

You are requested to kindly resolve the issue at the earliest.

Thanking you,

Regards

Secretary, R.W.A., Sector 8.

Ques4) What is a report? Discuss the features of a good report? What can be the purpose of a report?

Ans- The word 'report' has been derived from the Latin word '*reportare*' which means 'to carry back'. 'To carry back' here means to inform someone who was not present at the time of event. *A report means to give an account of something seen, heard or done. According to Lesikar, a business report is orderly and objective communication of factual information, that serves a business purpose.*

Characteristics/Features of a Report:

1. Orderly or Systematic.
2. Objective.
3. Factual- based on facts, not imaginary.
4. Purpose- Should serve a purpose.
5. Clarity- Use of unambiguous language.
6. Accuracy.
7. Reader Oriented.
8. Properly documented.

Purpose of a Report:

1. To give information
 2. Recommendations
 3. Description
 4. Details of Laboratory Tests
 5. Progress at Work
 6. Inspection
 7. Studies of Construction Projects
 8. Scientific Research
 9. Sales Efforts
 10. Planning Marketing Strategies
-

Ques5) What are the different types of Report?

Ans- Reports can be of many types:-

1. Formal and Informal Reports
 2. Periodic and Routine Reports
 3. Voluntary and Authorized Reports
 4. Internal and External Reports
 5. Short and Long Report
 6. Informational and Analytical Reports
-

Ques6) What are the different formats/ layouts of Reports?

Ans- There are four formats/ layouts:

1. Memo Report
2. Letter Report
3. Manuscript Format
4. Printed Format

1 -Memo Format Report

- It is used for internal communication within the organization.
- It is used to handle routine business matters, such as passing information from one department to other, making changes, alerting employees, solving a problem.

Sample of Memo Report

Inter- office Memorandum
Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd.

To: General Manager

From: XYZ

Personal Manager

26TH July 2015

Sub: Lack of work ethics among the company employees. Kindly refer to your memo dated 21st July 2015, instructing me to probe the complaints against the employees and suggest the steps that can be taken to bring about an improvement in the conditions.

Findings:

A survey of different departments, surprise checks and a dialogue with the persons coming with complaints have brought to light the following problems:

- i) 40% employees reported late for duty on three consecutive days.
- ii) 56% of employees, did not meet target on time.
- iii) 56 persons were found to be absent without leave application on July 24 and three on July 25.
- iv) Canteen is found to be crowded even during off- lunch break.
- v) Workers Union is becoming more aggressive. The above findings indicate lack of work ethics.

Recommendations:

- i) The late comers should be warned, failing compliance strict actions should be taken.
- ii) A number of incentives and disincentives may be introduced to make the employees achieve targets on time.
- iii) To sideline Union leader, the manager should itself bring some changes in environment.

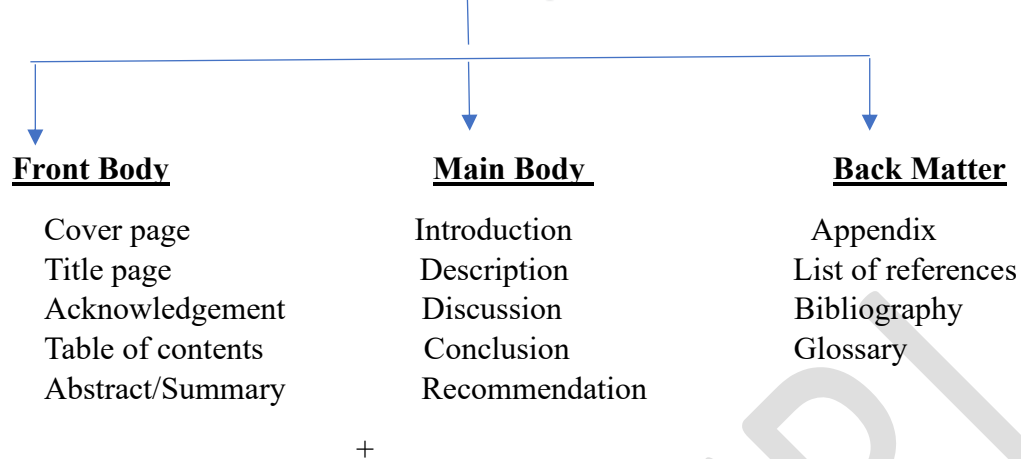
2-Letter Format Report

It presents information in the format of business letters. The difference is in writing style and organization of content.

3-Manuscript Format Report

It is the most commonly used format and is generally used for formal reports. As the length increases, it includes elements such as abstract, summary, appendix, glossary and so on.

Structure of a Formal Report



Front Body:

- Cover page: It protects the report from any damage.
- Title page: It includes the title of report, the name of the person who has submitted and to whom it is submitted.
- Acknowledgement: It is a 'thank you note' and contains the names of the people who have contributed in the preparation of the report.
- Table of Contents: It is an index that helps the reader in finding the topics easily.
- Abstract/Summary: Abstract is 2 to 5 percent of the report. Summary is 5 to 10 percent of the report.

Main Body:

- Introduction: It is the first part of the report. It contains the information about the subject of report. The name of the person who has authorized the report is there.
- Description: It contains the various aspects of the issue. There are headings and sub-headings. It may include charts, graphs and tables.
- Conclusion: The writer draws some definite conclusions on the basis of the facts and data.
- Recommendation: The writer puts forward some concrete suggestion.

Back Matter:

- Appendix: It contains statistical data, charts and diagrams that are not incorporated in the main body of the report.
- List of references: The work cited in the text are put together in the list.
- Bibliography: It includes the reference books, journals and dissertation.
- Glossary: It is the list of technical words used in the reports. It contains the explanation of different words.

Reports containing routine information may be written on a form prescribed by the organization.

QUES-7) What is the importance of oral communication?

Ans) *Of the many skills that contribute to professional success, the ability to communicate in front of a group of people is the most important.* Francis Bacon, a well - known essayist writes "Reading makes the full man, speaking perfect man and writing exact man."

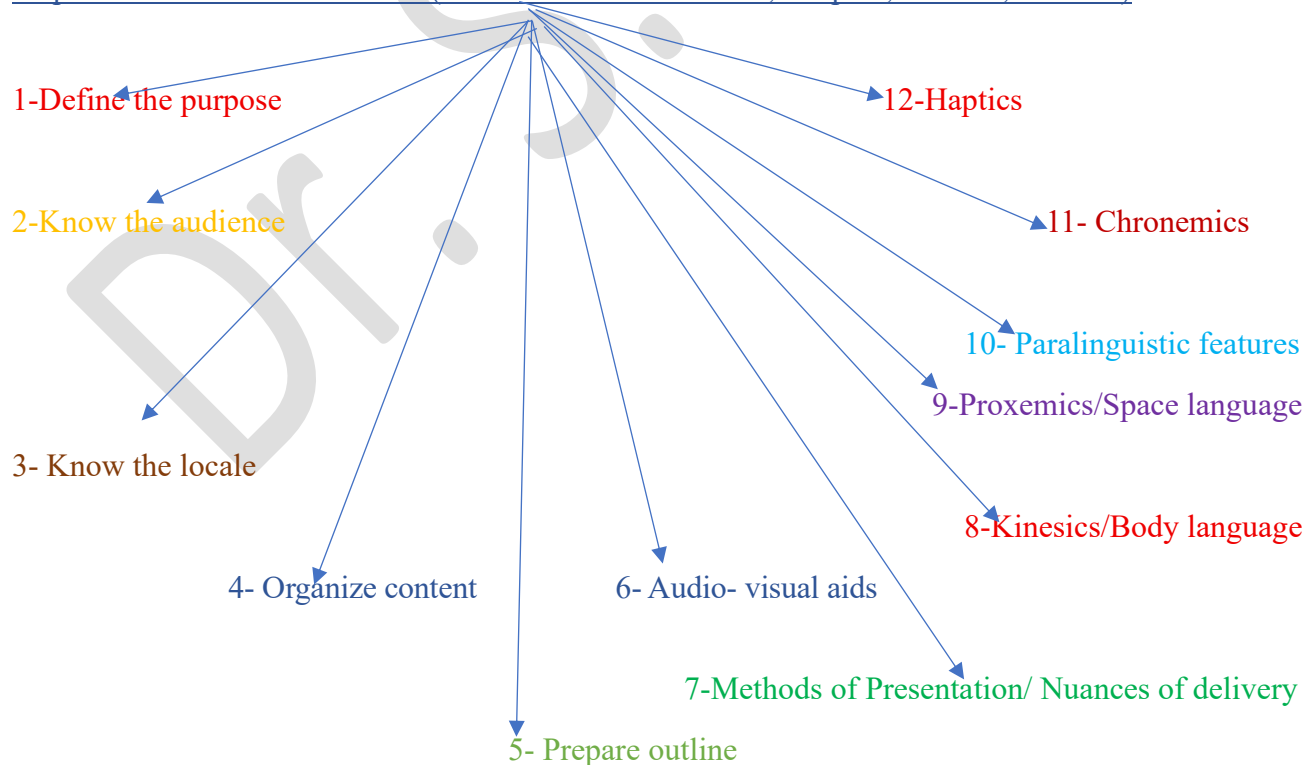
Whether one is a student, a professional engineer, an academician or a business executive, one may have to make oral presentation in front of one's colleagues or professional peers. A person making a presentation needs to understand the basic elements of an effective presentation: the 4 Ps - that is, Plan, Prepare, Practice and Perform.

QUES-8) Give some tips for a successful presentation or public speech.

Ans: *Presentation is a form of oral communication in which a person shares factual information with a particular audience.*

Presentation is a powerful medium of communication ideas and it involves a preplanned and organized structure. Speeches are difficult for most of us. The following techniques may help us:

Steps to Successful Presentation (Remember the 4 Ps - Plan, Prepare, Practice, Perform)



Define the Purpose

- One important aspect of presentation is to understand the purpose of your presentation.
Purpose can be:
 - To inform
 - To analyze
 - To persuade/ convince

Know your audience

The presenter should try to understand the audience and find out the answers for the following questions:

- Who is your audience?
- What is their purpose of attending our presentation?
- What is their background?
- What is their level of knowledge?
- What is their taste?
- Are they familiar with the topic?
- Age range?
- Gender distribution?

Know the locale

- Whether the place of presentation is a large auditorium or a small room.
- Whether we will have a public address system.
- Seating arrangements
- Room temperature and lighting.

Organize the content

The script should be prepared. *According to Dale Carnegie, "A well prepared / organized speech is nine-tenth delivery."* Develop each part of an oral presentation:

a) Introduction

- Get the attention of the audience.
- State the purpose of presentation.
- Give the background.

b) Main body

- Present the main points, backed by supporting material.
- Involve the audience's attention.
- Pause occasionally for questions or comments

c) Close/Conclusion

- Summarize the presentation.
- Repeat the main ideas.
- Use verbal as well as non- verbal clues to signal closure.

Audio-visual aids

- Blackboard/Whiteboard
- Flipchart
- Overhead Projectors
- LCD projectors.
- The person making the presentation should decide the method of presentation.

Methods of presentation/ Nuances of Delivery

- Presenting extemporaneously/extempore
- Memorizing
- Reading
- Impromptu / on the spot

Non- verbal Communication

During the presentation certain things should be kept in mind. The speaker should pay attention to the non-verbal communication:

- **Kinesics** – It includes personal appearance & gestures, posture, walking, facial expressions.
- **Proxemics** – Types of space language are: Intimate, Personal, Social, Public.
- **Paralanguage/ paralinguistic features/ nuances of Voice dynamics** - It includes: quality, volume, pitch, articulation, pronunciation, voice modulation
- **Chronemics** - It means time management.
- **Haptics**- It is touch- communication.

Last but not the least, language used in the presentation should be simple and acceptable at a general level.

Ques-9) Define purpose in presentation strategies. What is the need of defining the purpose for a speaker to make a presentation?

Ans- Presentation should understand the basic elements of an effective presentation- the 4Ps that is, plan, prepare, practice and perform. In defining the purpose of a presentation, a presentation should start by defining the purpose. It is impossible to give an effective presentation without knowing the purpose thoroughly. In the words of James Allen, *"That purpose is the royal road to true concentration of thought."*

The purpose of presentations is important as:

1. It decides the content and style in presentation.
2. It affects the amount of audience interaction.

The purpose of a presentation can be:

1. To inform
2. To analyze
3. To persuade

When our purpose is to persuade people to take a particular action, or to collaborate with them in solving a problem or making a decision, the interaction would be more. We generally begin by providing facts and figures. We might also offer argument in defense of certain conclusions and recommendations.

QUES-10) What is the need of audience and locale analysis?

Ans:

Analysis of Audience

Analysis of audience before beginning the presentation

One requirement of a good presentation is to know our audience. The presenter should try to understand this audience and find out the answers to the following questions for the preliminary analysis:

1. Who is our audience? How many persons will be there?
2. What is their purpose of attending our presentation?
3. What is their background?
4. What is their level of knowledge?
5. What is their taste?
6. Are they familiar with the topic?
7. What is their age?
8. Gender distribution?

Analysis of audience during the presentation

1-Analysis of the audience by observing the following:

- facial expressions
- Smile
- Blank stare
- Movement
- Sounds coming (or not coming)
- If their questions are in order

2- The audience forms an impression about the presenter from:

- Personal appearance
- Posture
- Walking
- Facial expressions
- Gestures
- Exactitude of expression
- Confidence

Analysis of locale

When we make a presentation, we should have the information about the following aspects:

- Whether the place of presentation is a large auditorium or a small conference room?
- Will there be a podium or table?
- Will there be a public address system?
- Availability of visual aids?
- Seating arrangements? Room temperature and lighting?

If we can identify the problems before and during the presentation, we can make the presentation effective.

Ques11-) Write a note on organizing contents.

Ans: According to Dale Carnegie, *"A well prepared speech is nine-tenths delivered."* Organizing the content of a presentation is just like preparing a dish before its delivery.

Before making a presentation, it is necessary to develop the following parts of an oral presentation:

- Introduction
- Main Body
- Close/Conclusion

Introduction:

"Well begun is half done."

- A good introduction aims at arousing the interest of the audience.
- It establishes the speaker's credibility and gives a preview of the content.
- To grip the reader's attention the opening sentence can be either:
 1. A question
 2. A quotation
 3. A simple statement
 4. A story related to the topic
 5. Some interesting statistics

Main Body:

According to Leanne Anderson, certain things should be kept in mind while developing the main body. The organization should be clear.

1. Presentation should be such as to hold the audience's attention.
2. The speaker should pause occasionally for questions or comments.

The main body of the presentation can be organized in any one or combination of the following orders:

- Inductive
- Deduction answer
- Chronological

- Facts and figures

Close Conclusion:

1. The speaker should sum up the presentation.
2. The speaker should be repeated in a memorable way.
3. The speakers should be motivated to go beyond.
4. Verbal techniques should be used intelligently to signal closure. Words and phrases such as "in conclusion", "lastly", "finally" may be used.
5. The speaker may thank the audience for their patient listening.
6. Non-verbal clues may be used to signal closure.

QUES-12) Describe the act of preparing an outline. Give its significance.

Ans) An outline serves as a guide to show the speaker the right path for his presentation. An outline prepared carefully may include the following points:

- Headings
 - Sub-headings
 - Indications
 - Transitional sentences or phrases
 - Notes
 - Headings should be given in complete sentences.
 - Sub-headings should be noted down.
 - Indications should be given regarding the use of visual aids.
 - Transitional sentences or phrases, such as 'in conclusion', 'in addition' should be written down.
-

QUES-13) Give the details of visual and audio- visual aids used in presentation. Add a few tips.

Ans: Famous Chinese philosopher Confucius said:

*"Tell me I will forget
Show me I may remember"*

We know that the spoken word is severely limited in communicating. We can make our presentation interesting and effective by using the visual and audio-visual aids.

Types of Visual and Audio-Visual Aids

Non-Projected	1. Poster	
	2. Flip chart	
	3. Presentation board	
	4. Real object	
	5. Chalkboard/Whiteboard	
	6. Photos	
	7. Handouts	
Projected	1. Overhead Transparencies	
	2. TV/VCR	
	3. Computer projection	

Do's and don'ts :

- Make certain that everyone in the audience can see the visuals.
- Organize the visual as a part in the presentation.
- Emphasize the visuals, point to them with physical action and words.
- Look at the visuals only when the audience should look at them.
- Avoid blocking the audience's view of the visuals.
- Do not use too many visuals as they will lessen their impact.
- Keep the visuals displayed for sufficient time to allow the audience to read it.

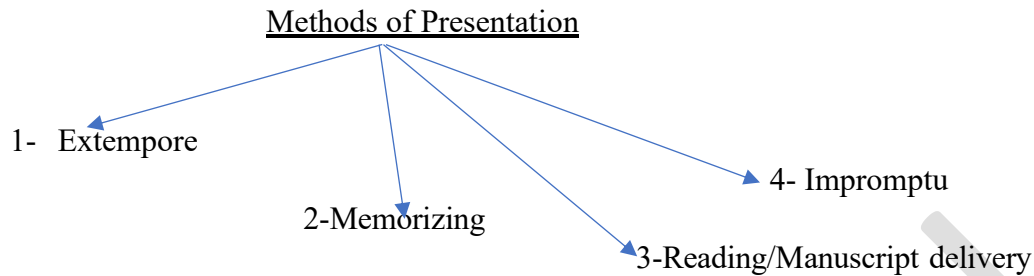
The importance of visual aids:

- Visual aids increase audience's interest.
 - They illustrate key points.
 - They signal transition from one point of the presentation to the next.
 - They increase the impact of the message.
 - Help the readers present ideas without depending on notes.
 - Make the difficult things or concepts understandable.
-

QUES-14) What can be the different Methods of presentation/ Nuances of delivery.

Ans: After organizing the speech we need to decide on our method of presentation.

Different methods/modes of delivery which can be used for making presentations are:



Extempore

It is without premeditation or preparation.

- It is a formal method, used in speeches and debates.
- This is the most popular and effective method.
- It is neither read nor memorized
- Extemporaneous presentations generally sound natural to the listeners

Memorizing

People memorize key passages and use notes to help them through

- The most difficult method.
- Sometimes the chances of rambling are very high.

Advantages (of Memorizing):

- Eye contact can be maintained easily with the audiences throughout the presentation.
- Appropriate non-verbal communication can be used by the speaker to add extra value to the speech.
- It is possible to finish the speech in allotted time.

Disadvantages (of Memorizing):

- Memorization requires a lot of time.
- Presentation can become dull and monotonous.
- No flexibility is possible during the speech.
- The speaking becomes panic-stricken if he forgets a word, a sentence, or a whole paragraph.

Reading/Manuscript delivery

In manuscript presentation, we read the written material.

- This method is suitable for a proficient reader.
- For the effective use of this method, a presenter should go through the material several times.

Advantages (of Reading):

- It is a permanent and accurate record of whatever we have to say.
- The material is presented systematically.
- It is easier to give chronological data with facts and figures.
- It is the best method to use if we have very limited time for an assigned period.

Disadvantages (of Reading):

- We get less time for making proper eye contact with the audience.
- There is not much scope for non-verbal communication.
- If we are not proficient readers, the speech becomes uninteresting.

Impromptu

It is an informal speech without preparation. E.g. At a dinner party we may be invited to deliver a vote of thanks.

- Before an impromptu speech, we should calmly state our topic and then preview the points we are to make.
- We should support our points with whatever examples, quotes and anecdotes we recall at that time.
- The speaker should be to summarize or restore our points, and conclude with a smile.
- It should be as brief as possible during our impromptu presentation.

Advantages (of Impromptu):

- We sound very natural.
- We are spontaneous.
- We get a chance to express our thoughts irrespective of what others think or say about that particular topic.

Disadvantages (of Impromptu):

- The presentation lacks organized development of ideas because of the shortage of time.
 - There is no supplementary material to substantiate the speech.
 - Chances of rambling are very high.
-

QUES-15) Kinesics /Body language is critical in oral communication. Elucidate.

Ans: *Kinesics is the name given to study of the body's physical movements.* It is non-verbal communication or we can say that it is communication without words. In oral presentations and interviews, kinesics plays an important role. Body language includes the following aspects of our:

- a. Personal Appearance
- b. Posture
- c. Gesture
- d. Walking
- e. Facial Expressions

Personal Appearance

People see us before they hear us. One's personal appearance can put the audience into a good or hostile attitude. Appearance includes clothes, hair, jewellery, cosmetics and so on.

Tips

- Dress in a manner appropriate for the audience and the occasion.
- Be clean and well groomed.
- Remember "first impression is the last impression."

Posture

Posture generally refers to the way we hold ourselves when we stand, sit or walk. The way one sits, stands and walks reveals a lot.

Slumped posture	Low spirits
Erect posture	High spirits, energy, confidence
Lean forward	Open, honest and interested
Lean backward	Defensive or disinterested
Crossed arms	Defensive and not ready to listen
Uncrossed arms	Willingness to listen

Gesture

Gesture is the movement made by hands, arms, shoulders, head etc. Gestures are more effective than any other form of non-verbal communication. Gestures can roughly be divided into the following types:

- Enumerative
- Symbolic
- Descriptive
- Emphatic

Don'ts:

- Don't use distracting gestures.
- Don't play with a cap.
- Don't twirl your chain.

- Don't crack knuckles.
- Avoid putting your hands in your pockets.
- Don't scratch, bite nails, tap your feet.
- Don't cross arm or legs.
- Don't clear your throat too often.

Walking

A person making a presentation should walk with his head upright. He should swing freely on his sides. Eyes should look straight in front. Steps should be well measured and steady.

Facial Expressions

"Face is the index of mind." The person making the oral presentation should keep a pleasant face with a natural tendency to smile.

Five Basic Expressions are:

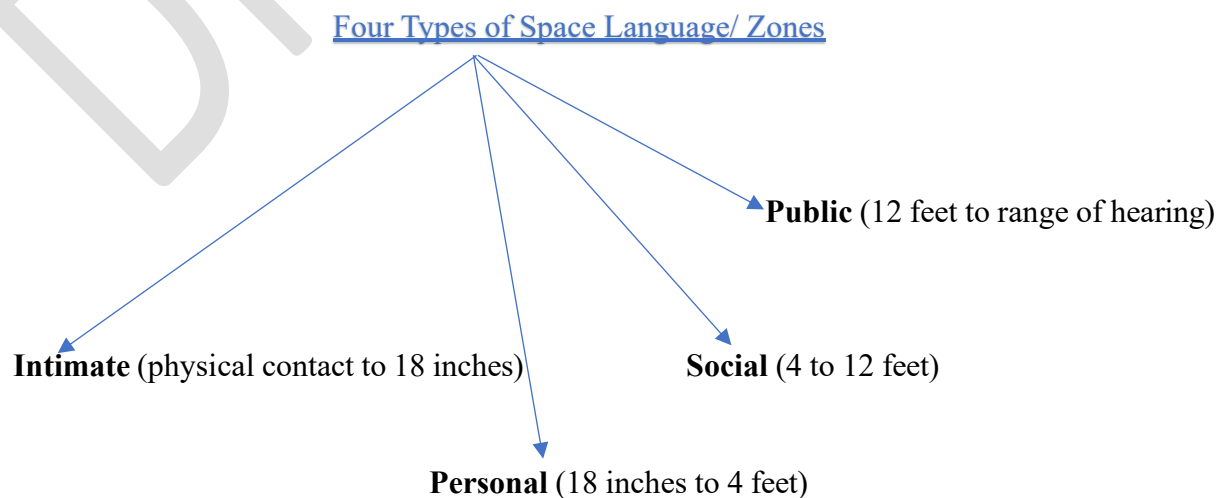
- 1- Inhibited (restricted and solid)
- 2- Uninhibited (spontaneous)
- 3- Surprise (happy with a long type)
- 4- Blank (no expression)
- 5- Frozen (no change in expression)

The speaker should maintain a steady eye contact *"Eyes are the windows to our soul"*

QUES-10) State the importance of Proxemics in oral communication.

Ans: *Proxemics means the space language.* Space dimensions or distance between us and other people tells us about our relations with others and the nature of our communication with them.

Edward T. Hall has given four types of space language.



Intimate

Only family members and close friends fall under this zone. The best example is the space between mother and baby. The speaker speaks at a very low pitch.

Personal

Here the speaker and the listener are in the personal space i.e. from 18 inches to 4 feet. In this space we can have normal conversation.

Social

This social space language is used for formal purposes. Most of the business is done in this area.

Public

In this area space communication becomes formal, and the speaker speaks at a loud pitch so that the audience can hear him. The best example is- the space between political leader and the audience.

QUES-11) How can Paralinguistic features or Nuances of Voice dynamics help the speaker to make his presentation impressive?

Ans) Paralanguage means 'like language'. It is a type of non-verbal communication. *Paralanguage is the communication effect of speed, pitch, volume of spoken words.*

Characteristic Nuances /Features of voice:

1. Quality
2. Volume
3. Pace/Speed
4. Pitch
5. Articulation
6. Pronunciation
7. Voice Modulation
8. Pause

Quality(of Voice)

Everybody can improve the quality of their voice and develop it to its full potential. Abraham

Lincoln and Winston Churchill, for example, adapted the quality their voices to become excellent orators.

Volume

Volume is loudness or softness of voice. Small place: Volume should be low. A very high volume may sound bored or insensitive. Large and open place: Volume should be high. A very low volume conveys an impression of fear or confidence.

Pace/Rate

Rate is the number of words which we speak per minute. The normal rate is from 120 to 150 words per minute.

Pitch

Pitch refers to the number of vibrations per second of our voice.

- A well- balanced pitch results in a clear and effective tone.
- High pitch: suggests excitement, joy, triumph, anger.
- Low pitch: suggests shock, guilt, sadness, dullness.

Articulation

It is the ability to speak distinctly, produce the sounds in a crisp and lucid manner.

Example:

- 1- I do not know. (right articulation)
- 2- I dunno. (wrong articulation)

Pronunciation

Good pronunciation makes us to speak our sounds in a way that it is generally accepted. The best way is to follow British Received Pronunciation.

Voice modulation

Voice modulation means the way we regulate, vary or adjust the tone, pitch and volume of the sound.

- We should pay attention to the word stress and sentences stress which play an important role in voice modulation.

Pause

A pause is a short silence flanked by words.

QUES-12) Chronemics / Time- dimension is an important factor of presentation strategy. Explain.

Ans: *Chronemics/ time dimension means time management. It is the study of how human beings communicate through their use of time.*

It is the most important thing at a work place is the management of time. When we are late for an appointment, people react negatively. If we arrive early, we are considered either over eager or aggressive.

During the presentation if the speaker keeps himself within the limits to time allowed, he can achieve his goal.

Examples:

1-Long speech- It becomes boring. Soon the listeners lose interest.

2- A very short speech- The audience doesn't understand the message properly. It also shows lack of preparation and confidence.

A speaker should strike a balance. Good presentation requires careful planning, effective visual aids and diligent rehearsals.

Ques-13) What is Haptics?

Ans- *Haptics is touch communication. It is a non-verbal communication that uses physical contact to convey messages, emotions and intentions.* How one person touches another communicates a great deal of information.

Is it a good gentle touch?

Is it an aggressive touch?

Examples of haptics are- shaking hands, hugging, kicking, slapping, patting etc.

Key Aspects of Touch Communication:

- Touch can be used to convey a wide range of emotions.
- It complements verbal communication.
- Acceptable and unacceptable touches are socially learnt.
- Touch can sometimes be misinterpreted.
- It plays an important role in establishing and maintaining relationships.
- It has therapeutic benefits.
- Touch is a fundamental form of communication used by animals as well.

-----END OF MODULE 3-----

Dr. S. JAFRI